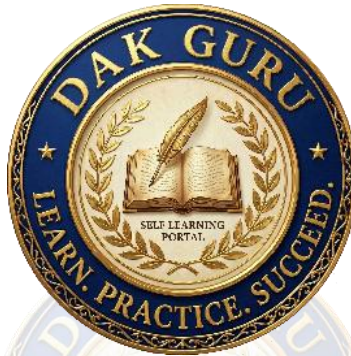

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POSTAL MANUAL VOLUME V

Exam-Focused Edition

Railway Mail Service • Mail Operations • Bagging • Investigations • Weighment

Current • In-Force • High-Yield Rules Only

LDCE — Inspector of Posts | PS Group 'B' | PA / SA | IPO

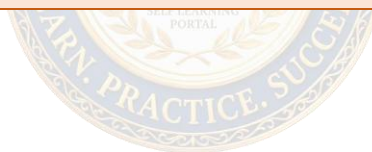
Aligned to the Post Office Act, 2023 and the Post Office Rules & Regulations, 2024

Disclaimer

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. It is a curated, high-yield study aid — not a complete reproduction of the Postal Manual Volume V. It deliberately concentrates on rules that are current, practically in force, and frequently examined, and omits provisions that are obsolete or no longer in practice (each such omission is flagged with the reason).

*With effect from 18 June 2024, the **Post Office Act, 2023** replaced the Indian Post Office Act, 1898; and with effect from 16 December 2024 the **Post Office Rules, 2024** and **Post Office Regulations, 2024** superseded the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933. The Manual continues as administrative practice only to the extent it is not inconsistent with the new law.*

Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and currency as on June 2026. Aspirants are nevertheless advised to verify any provision against official Government sources, the Gazette of India and the latest Directorate circulars before relying on it for service or examination purposes. Dak Guru accept no liability for any consequence arising from the use of this material.



Coverage Philosophy — What's In, What's Out

This edition is built on one principle: **study what is current, in force, and likely to be tested**. The Postal Manual Volume V is a large, century-old compilation; much of its procedural detail has been overtaken by computerisation (CSI), the Mail and Parcel Network Optimisation Projects, and the new Post Office Act / Rules / Regulations of 2023–24. Reproducing every clause would bury the examinable core under dead matter.

What is INCLUDED

- **Definitions and organisational structure** of the RMS and the post-office hierarchy — the bedrock of objective questions.
- **Bundling, bagging and check-slip rules** with their numeric thresholds and colour codes.
- **Stamping, postmark, weight and time-frame rules** that still govern counter and sorting work.
- **Investigation and weighment rules** with current monetary limits and the BNSS-updated legal references.
- **Modern practice context** — MNOP/PNOP hubs (NSH, ICH, L1, L2), CSI, DIGIPIN — where it has replaced the Manual's older arrangements.

What is OMITTED (and why it is flagged)

Wherever a rule or block is left out, a grey “Omitted — and why” box states the reason. Broadly, three categories are trimmed:

1. **Superseded by new law** — e.g., penalty/offence rules removed by the Post Office Act, 2023, or fee/late-posting rules changed by 2022–24 notifications.
2. **Obsolete in practice** — manual procedures replaced by CSI/IT systems, or arrangements made redundant by MNOP/PNOP.
3. **Low examination value** — long internal procedural clauses that rarely feature in objective papers (noted, not detailed).

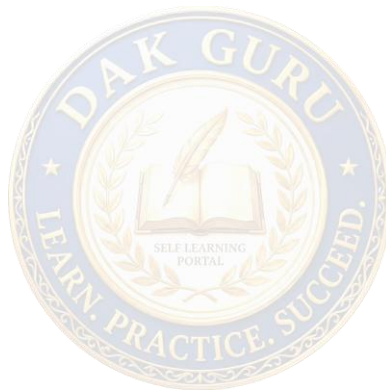
LEGEND

LEGISLATIVE NOTE — the statutory basis of a rule.

CURRENCY UPDATE — what has changed under recent law / orders (the exam-critical box).



NOTE / MEMORY AID — a tested definition, distinction or number, or a memory hook.
OMITTED — AND WHY — a rule / block left out, with the reason stated.



The New Legislative Framework (Read First)

The single biggest change to postal law in 125 years: the colonial-era statute and rules have been replaced. The Manual itself has *not* been withdrawn — it continues to govern operations as administrative practice, except where it conflicts with the new law (the saving clause).

LEGISLATIVE NOTE — The Three Pillars

- 1. Post Office Act, 2023** (Act 43 of 2023) — assent 24.12.2023; in force **18 June 2024**. Repealed the 1898 Act. 16 sections (old Act had 77); removes all penalties / offences.
- 2. Post Office Rules, 2024** (G.S.R. 767(E)) — in force **16 December 2024**; supersede the 1933 Rules. 19 rules.
- 3. Post Office Regulations, 2024** (S.O. 5440(E)) — in force **16 December 2024**. 180 regulations covering operational detail of every product/service.

The Saving Clause — Why this Volume Still Matters

Section 16(2) of the Post Office Act, 2023 provides that all rules, notifications and orders under the old Act **continue in force** — so far as not inconsistent with the new Act — until superseded. The new Rules/Regulations are deliberately high-level; the procedural detail for RMS and mail operations still lives in this Manual. That is why it remains the working reference, and why this booklet keeps its in-force rules.

Quick Map: Old vs New

Subject	Old	Current (in force)
Parent Act	Indian Post Office Act, 1898	Post Office Act, 2023 (18.06.2024)
Subordinate Rules	Indian Post Office Rules, 1933	Post Office Rules, 2024 (16.12.2024)
Operational detail	Rules + Manuals	Post Office Regulations, 2024 + Manuals
Criminal procedure	CrPC, 1973	BNSS, 2023 (01.07.2024)
Penalties / offences	Many (Ss. 49, 52 etc.)	Abolished; dues = land-revenue arrears
Letter monopoly	Govt. exclusive privilege (S. 4)	Abolished; private couriers recognised
This Manual	Primary reference	Continues as practice (saving clause)

Chapter 1 — Definitions & Organisational Structure

Chapter 1 of the Manual defines the entire post-office and RMS machinery. These definitions are the single richest source of one-mark questions. This edition covers the in-force definitions, including the basic hierarchy and the modern IT-enabled units that the older notes left out. Focus on **who is in charge**, the **abbreviations**, and the **one-line distinctions** between similar offices.

Rules 3–8 — The Post-Office Hierarchy

The backbone of the network is a three-tier office structure, each with its own in-charge designation:

Office	Definition (short)	In-Charge
Head Office (HO)	Main office of account for itself and all SOs/BOs in its group; their transactions are incorporated in its accounts.	Head Postmaster
Sub-Office (SO)	Subordinate to and in account with an HO; its monetary transactions are incorporated in the HO's accounts.	Sub-Postmaster
Branch Office (BO)	Lower status than an SO; in direct account with an HO/SO (its "accounts office"). The lowest unit of the post office.	Branch Postmaster

- **Superintendent of Post Offices (SPOs):** The chief officer in charge of a Postal Division; the Superintendent of RMS holds the equivalent position for an RMS Division. Both are immediately subordinate to the Head of Circle / Region.

MEMORY AID

Tier order: Head Office → Sub-Office → Branch Office. In-charges: Head Postmaster → Sub-Postmaster → Branch Postmaster. The BO is the lowest unit. A "town branch office" is a BO in a town/suburb that also has an HO.

Rule 2 — Railway Mail Service (RMS)

The service responsible for the carriage of mails by **rail, road, river and air**, and for the collection and distribution of mails received from Post Offices by Mail Offices and Sections. Despite the name, the RMS is multi-modal.

Rules 5-A / 5-B / 5-C — Satellite & Hybrid Services

- **V-SAT Stations (5-A):** Important Head Post Offices identified as Very Small Aperture Terminal stations; money orders are transmitted from them using satellite technology.
- **Extended Satellite Money Order – ESMO (5-B):** Extension counters for booking / transmitting money orders through V-SAT stations.
- **Hybrid Mail Service (5-C):** Electronic transmission of written material via VSAT-linked terminals, printed and delivered to one or more addressees at the receiving station.

CURRENCY UPDATE

V-SAT/ESMO and early Hybrid Mail reflect older technology. Electronic remittance now runs as eMO / iMO on the CSI platform, and the Money Order ceiling is ₹10,000 under the Post Office Regulations, 2024 (retail money remittance capped at ₹25,000). The definitions are retained for completeness; the operative limits are those of the 2024 Regulations.

Rules 9 – 11 — Sorting & Transit Offices

- **Sorting Office (Rule 9/10):** An office charged with opening sorting mail bags received by it and disposing of their contents.
- **Sorting Sub-Office (Rule 11):** A sub-office at or near the junction of several mail lines, selected to act as a Sorting Office for articles routed through it; authorised to receive articles of all kinds in sorting.
- **Transit Office (Rule 9-A):** Any Post Office on a through mail line that receives and sorts bags for offices in advance without opening them. Bags forwarded unopened are forward bags; the purpose is to reduce loose bags.

Transit Mail Office – TMO (Rule 9-B)

A branch of the RMS where closed bags are received and dispatched; **sorting of letters is not done** here. In-charge: a Mail Agent / Mail Guard. Functions in sets (e.g., Bangalore City TMO Set 1: 06:00–14:00; Set II: 14:00–21:40). Night-set batches work on alternate nights.

- **Computerised TMO (Rule 9-C):** A TMO where the work is handled on computers, provided in certain cities.

Modern Sorting Units (Rules 10-A / 10-B)

- **Automatic Mail Processing Centre (AMPC):** Mechanised letter-sorting centres using automatic sorting machines (e.g., at metros) — a modern addition to the Manual.
- **Computerised Registration Centre (CRC):** The registration branch of a Mail Office where registration processing is done on computers (may be co-located or separate).

CURRENCY UPDATE — MNOP/PNOP has Reshaped the Network

Under the Mail Network Optimization Project (MNOP, launched 2010), Speed Post centres became National Sorting Hubs (NSH) and Intra-Circle Hubs (ICH), and CRCs became Registered L1 / L2 hubs. The Parcel Network Optimization Project (PNOP, 2018) created L1/L2 Parcel Hubs. From 7 December 2024, Speed Post and Registered hubs were merged for common processing (Directorate order 30-10/2022-D dated 17.10.2024). Indicative current counts: ~93 NSH, ~148 ICH, ~91 Registered L1 and ~225 Registered L2 offices. For exams, remember: MNOP first applied to Speed Post; tracked by KPIs (D+X, Full Scan Compliance, etc.); tools — BI Tool, IPVS, AWB tracking.

Rules 11-A / 11-B — Nodal PO & Central Bagging Unit

- **Nodal Post Office (11-A):** In important cities/towns, POs authorised to receive letters from neighbouring POs and sort them per a sorting diagram from the RMS Superintendents — to reduce peak-hour pressure on local sorting offices.
- **Central Bagging Unit / KBU (11-B):** An RMS branch where bundles from POs/Mail Offices (arriving in 'L'/'R' bags) are grouped by destination (Circle/District/PO-wise) and enclosed in direct bags for onward delivery or transmission.

Rule 12 — Returned Letter Office (RLO)

Deals with unclaimed and refused articles, and articles without addresses or with undecipherable / incomplete addresses. Acts as an *enquiry office* (to trace deliverable articles) and as the deposit office for undeliverable “returned” articles. Letters are retained about **three months**, articles of value up to **one year**, then auctioned.

CURRENCY UPDATE — 4 Zonal RLOs

The earlier one-RLO-per-Circle system was rationalised (Directorate order Mails/Misc/1/2023-D dated 21.08.2023). The network is now consolidated into FOUR Zonal RLOs; e.g., Delhi RLO closed w.e.f. 01.10.2023, its work mapped to Lucknow (Northern Zone).

Zone	Zonal RLO
Eastern	Kolkata
Western	Mumbai
Northern	Lucknow
Southern	Chennai

- **Transcription Centre (Rule 12-A):** A cell in a Sorting Office (normally at Circle HQ) that transcribes into English the addresses written in regional languages on postal articles.

Rule 13 — Offices Handling International Mail

LEGISLATIVE NOTE

The functional classification of international-mail offices was revised by Directorate communication (04.04.2022), read with Customs notifications designating Foreign Post Offices.

Office	Function
Office of Exchange (OE)	Makes up / exchanges international mails with foreign OEs after customs clearance; may be outward, inward or both; maintains exchange accounts & indemnity cases.

Office	Function
Office of Exchange of Transit	Receives / dispatches only closed mail bags to / from OEs; forwards “Closed Transit” foreign-origin bags to destination countries.
Foreign Post Office (FPO)	An OE where Customs examination / assessment / clearance is done. Duty assessed only for articles delivered within its jurisdiction; others diverted to the appropriate FPO.
Sub-Foreign Post Office (SFPO)	Handles inbound/outbound international mail for mapped offices; no direct exchange with other countries; does customs exam/assessment for its mail.

NOTE

An SFPO not yet equipped for customs assessment works as an International Business Centre (IBC) until the facility starts. The export-oriented counterpart is the Dak Niryat Kendra (DNK) / Dak Ghar Niryat Kendra (DNK) under the postal-exports scheme.

Rule 14 — Transit Sections

Travelling RMS offices on railway / river-steamer lines. The set’s officer-in-charge is a Mail Guard / Mail Agent (SA). Sections are numbered serially and designated by the RMS Division name + serial number (e.g., DN-1).

Rule 15 — Mail Office (and Bulk-Mail Units)

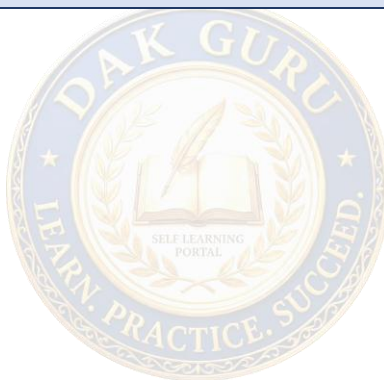
Mail Offices are stationary RMS units, distinct from TMOs:

Feature	Sorting Mail Office	Mail Office	Transit Mail Office (TMO)
Content handled	Ordinary L Bags	RL / SP / PL	Only closed bags
In-charge	Head Sorting Assistant	Head Sorting Assistant	Mail Agent (SA)
Designation	L1U / L2U	NSH / ICH / NPH / PH	MA

- **Corporate Mail Office / Bulk Mail Centre – CMO/BMO (15-A):** Opened in big cities for corporate mail. A **bulk mailer** is a firm able to post **5,000 unregistered / 250 registered** articles at a time; supplied a customised sorting list; bundles entered on an invoice (in duplicate).
- **Mass Mailing Centre – MMC (15-B):** Assistance centre for very large-volume customers; pre-mailing activities are done here (also a function of the Business Post Centre).
- **Press Sorting Office – PSO (15-C):** On a newspaper's premises; wages, establishment and stationery borne by the publisher; deals **only** with second-class articles (denotes L2S). Works to the paper's dispatch timing.

NOTE

Mail offices at railway stations are designated by station name + "RMS" (e.g., Delhi RMS); those not at stations are designated Sorting Offices.



Rules 16–18 — Record Offices

Administrative units for work-papers and staff matters:

Type	HRO (Head Record Office)	SRO (Sub-Record Office)	RO (Record Office)
Location	RMS Division HQ	Same Division (Non-HQ)	Same Division (Non-HQ)
In-charge	Head Record Officer (HSG-I)	Sub Record Officer (LSG)	Record Officer (SA)
Functions	Work papers of all HQ offices; salary / contingent bills for the entire division	Work papers of offices under its jurisdiction	Work papers of sections attached to it

Rule 18-A — Bag Office

Bag-accounting classification of offices (to avoid unnecessary bag movement):

Type	Unit Bag Office (UBO)	District Bag Office (DBO)	Circle Bag Office (CBO)
Entity	Every PO except BOs / EDSOs	Every HRO / SRO (exceptionally HO)	Postal Stores Depot (at Circle HQ)
Function	Maintains Day Bag Book; daily bag-balance report to DBO; min/max balance fixed yearly (preferably 1 July)	Category-wise bag account for Sorting Offices, TMOs & attached UBOs	Inspection of DBO/UBO; verifies balances; procurement, repair & auction of bags

NOTE

The “D” Section of the Postal Directorate is the Central Bag Office — it handles no bags, only correspondence on procurement / distribution of bags.

Rules 19–23 — Staff, Sets, Trips & Articles

- **Sorting Assistant (19):** RMS operative staff (excluding supervisors / mail guards) engaged in sorting work.
- **Subsidiary Sorting Assistant (20):** An SA who works in a Sorting Office for only part of its hours to assist a heavy set.
- **Sets (21):** Numbered serially; for sections the number is preceded by the section name (e.g., A-26 / Set No. 4). Each set of the same section has identical hours, strength and mail exchange. A Mail Office's sets may differ in hours and pattern (alternate-night sets use 'Batch A' / 'Batch B').
- **Trip (22):** A journey by a set of a section from one end of its beat to the other. Towards the out-station = **Out-trip**; towards HQ = **In-trip**.
- **Station vs Sorting Articles (23):** **Station articles** — for delivery from the office they are sent to. **Sorting articles** — to be sorted and forwarded onward to destination / other Sorting Offices.

OMITTED — AND WHY

A few purely descriptive sub-definitions (e.g., "beat", "face and facing") are mentioned only in passing rather than detailed, as they rarely carry independent marks. Beat = the portion of a railway/steamer line over which a section works; Face/Facing = arranging articles address-side up, all turned the same way.

Chapter 2 — Mail Operations & Bagging Procedures

The operational heart of the volume. Examiners mine this chapter for **numeric thresholds** (how many articles make a bundle / warrant a bag), **check-slip colours**, and **symbols**. Long internal procedural clauses (Rules 42–55, 60–73, 86–102, 112–134, 137–144, 156–171) are now largely handled by CSI and are low-yield; they are noted, not reproduced.

Rule 24 — Labelled Bundles

A collection of faced unregistered letter-mail articles tied with a check-slip at the top, treated in sorting as a single article. These are “*not due*” items. Main types:

- **Station Bundle:** Prepared at **15 or more** unregistered articles for one station.
- **Territorial Bundle:** For a state / defined tract / foreign country at **25 or more** articles.
- **Sorting Bundle:** Unregistered articles for multiple stations.
- **Express Bundle:** Articles needing immediate sorting on receipt.
- **Deferred Bundle:** Articles that can be disposed of later.

MEMORY AID

Station = 15+ (one station). Territorial = 25+ (state / tract / foreign). Wider geography → higher threshold.

Rule 25 — Check Slip (Colour Codes)

A label tied to the top of a labelled bundle; its colour signals the contents at a glance:

Check-Slip	Used For
Pink	Ordinary Station Paid & Unpaid bundles
White	Ordinary Sorting bundles (both express & deferred). Express → add 2 diagonal lines in blue pencil on the face
Blue	Foreign air-mail bundles (marked “Air Mail”)

Strip Markings

Strip	Indicates
Green	Local articles
Yellow	Rajdhani bundles

Strip	Indicates
Blue	Metro bundles

- **Money Order Check-slip (25-A):** Form M.O. 70 in **red ink** on white / Badami paper, for money-order bundles.

Rules 26 / 26-A — Mail Bags & Airmail Bag

Mail bags are of three kinds: Station, Sorting and Combined mail bags. A Cash + Register bag inside a Mail Bag is marked with symbol “F” on the label.

Airmail Bag (26-A)

- **Carriage:** Under the “All-Up Scheme”; a blue dosuti bag is ordinarily used.
- **Weight limit:** Air-mail bag / air TB must not exceed **30 kg**.
- **Air cover instead of bag:** If articles are **fewer than 50** (no insured / air parcels), use an air-mail cover.
- **Air parcel enclosed:** Label bears “C.A.P”.
- **Registered articles in bag:** Only if **more than 25**, or bulky, or with insured; else tied crosswise with a ‘REGISTERED’ check-slip.

Rules 27–29 — Registered & Insured Bundles / Bags

Item	Threshold / Key Point
Registered Bundle (27)	More than 2 (min 3) registered articles.
Registered Bag (28)	A Due Bag ; holds cash bag, registered/insured items & MO bundles with a registered list. Cash bag inside → symbol ‘F’.
Insured Bundle (29)	More than 1 (min 2) insured articles; separate insured bag if they usually exceed 10.

MEMORY AID

Registered bundle = 3+ (more than 2). Insured bundle = 2+ (more than 1). Separate insured bag if insured items usually exceed 10. Registered articles in an air bag only if more than 25.

Rules 30–37-A — Classification of Bags

Due Bags (regular)	Unusual Bags (ad-hoc)
Transit Bag	Parcel Bag
Account Bag	Packet Bag
BO Bag	Cash Bag
Registered Bag	Special Bag
Mail Bag	Camp Bag

NOTE

Cash bags are NOT due bags — ordinarily sent inside account / registered / BO bags. Account bags ARE due bags and may contain all types of articles. A registered bag inside a mail bag is shown by symbol 'F' (some references use 'P' in the D.M. list).

Rules 40–47 — Definitions & Orders

Term	Meaning
Changing Station	Where the beats of two Transit Sections join (e.g., DN-1-Out ends at Delhi; J-3-IN starts Delhi→Ajmer).
Connecting Section	An RMS section in a train connecting immediately with another train carrying another RMS section.
A Orders	Issued by Supdt, RMS — changes in sorting lists.
B Orders	Issued by Supdt, RMS — guidance on all subjects except sorting-list changes. 'T' prefix = camp articles/bags for officials on tour.

Rules 52-A & 56-A — Sorting List; Late Letters

- **Due Mail List:** Bags to be received / dispatched by a Mail Office or Transit Section.
- **Sorting List:** Shows (a) offices for which mail/registered bags are made up, and (b) offices to which parcel-mail may be sent direct and how.
- **Late vs Too Late Letters:** Late = posted after closing **with** the late fee; Too Late = posted after closing **without** it.

CURRENCY UPDATE — Late Fee Abolished

By Gazette notification G.S.R. 912(E) dated 29.12.2022, Rule 196 of the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933 was substituted so that any article presented at the window during prescribed hours is simply accepted for dispatch — no separate late fee. The “late / too late” distinction is now academic. (Position carried forward under the Post Office Regulations, 2024.)

Rules 57-A – 59 — Trial Cards, Posting Hours, Letter Boxes

- **Trial Cards (57-A):** Service post cards (**M 26(a)**) to test alternative routes or trace detention; returned in a service cover to the issuing officer and **not** included in any station bundle.

Latest hours for posting (Rule 58):

Category	Latest Hour
Night Mails	Ordinarily 6 p.m.
Day Mails	30 minutes before the mail-closing hour
Railway Forwarding	Reach station 10 minutes before the train’s arrival

- **Clearance of Letter Boxes (59):** Cleared at convenient intervals during the day to expedite dispatch preparation.

Rules 74–76 — Bag Classifications; Air-Mail Bills

Feature	Plural Mail Bag	Extra Mail Bag
Category	Due Bag	Unusual Bag
Usage	As a Registered bag	As an Unregistered bag

- **Inland Air-Mail Delivery (76/2): Six copies** of delivery bills [M-57, M-57(a), M-57(b)] per port of call: 1st copy → Air Mail Accounts Section (Directorate); 4 copies → Air Carrier Agent with the mails; office copy → retained with the Agent's receipt.

Rules 85–111-A — Marks, Postmarks & Stamping

Rule	Key Point
85 — Distinguishing Marks	Insured → “Ins”; V.P. → “V.P.”; Regd./Insured bundle → “R.B.” / “I.B.”; Postal Service regd. → cipher “O”.
103 / 103-A — Postmarks	MO / unpaid stamp impressions kept in a separate book of postmarks under the Postmaster's personal custody; cleaning recorded daily (Order Book – HO / Error Book – SO / Rough Notebook – RMS).
107 — Stamping	Two stamps → one impression covering both, greater part on cover; block of four → one central impression; uncanceled inward foreign stamps → cancel with ink/indelible stroke, do NOT date-stamp.
111-A — Foreign Deficiency	OE impresses a “T” stamp ; amount = twice the deficient postage .

Rules 135–136 — Weight Limits; Supply of Lists

Carrier / Type	Maximum Weight
Letter Mail Runner (Main Line)	14 kg
Parcel Bag (RMS Trolley)	37 kg
Postman / Village Postman	10 kg (incl. parcels/cash)
Special Parcel Runner	14 kg /parcel; max 28 kg /man

- **Supply of Due Mail & Sorting Lists – M-9 (136):** POs in direct RMS communication → by Supdt, RMS Division; other offices → by Supdt, Post Offices; Village Sorting Lists (M-52) → by the Sub-Division Head. (Offices in more than one RMS Division → by the Head of Circle.)

Rules 145–155 — Irregularities, Interception, Redelivery, Returns

- **Record of Irregularities (145):** Post Offices → Error Book; RMS Sorting Assistants → Rough Notebook.
- **Interception (147):** Departmental procedure: ordered by Member (O) / Head of Circle / Regional Head; in emergency the Divisional Head may order it but must inform within **3 days** and obtain confirmation within **7 days**.

CURRENCY UPDATE — Interception Now Statutory

Interception is now governed by Section 9 of the Post Office Act, 2023 read with Rules 16–18 of the Post Office Rules, 2024. Grounds: security of State, friendly foreign relations, public order, emergency, public safety, or contravention of law. Under Rule 16(11) directions remain in force (unless revoked) for not more than 30 days, extendable but not beyond 90 days; thereafter the item goes to the law-enforcement authority. The Manual's 3-/7-day procedure continues only so far as consistent with this.

- **Redelivery / Address Alteration (148):** Fee **₹6/-** (international ₹30/-) to recall or alter address / name without the addressee's consent; **free** if the new address is within the same PO's delivery area.

LEGISLATIVE NOTE

Now codified in Regulation 57 of the Post Office Regulations, 2024. The ₹6 domestic recall/alteration fee remains current.

- **Half-Yearly Enumeration Returns (155):** Second week of **February & August (8th–21st, inclusive)**; copy forwarded by the **15th** to Head of Circle (HOs) / Head Office (SOs).

OMITTED — AND WHY

Large procedural blocks of Chapter 2 — detailed sorting / dispatch / mail-list / bag-handling steps (Rules 42–55, 60–73, 86–102, 112–134, 137–144, 156–171) — are not reproduced. Reason: most are step-by-step manual procedures now performed within CSI and the MNOP/PNOP hub workflow, and they seldom appear as objective questions. The examinable definitions and numbers from these ranges are captured above and in the Quick Revision.

Chapter 3 — Investigations

Covers how the Department investigates loss, fraud and theft, and which authority is competent at each money level. The **monetary limits** and the **updated legal references** are the high-yield points.

Rule 172-A — Investigation of Offences

LEGISLATIVE NOTE — New Criminal Laws

From 01.07.2024, the CrPC, 1973 is replaced by the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (BNSS); the IPC by the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 (BNS); and the Evidence Act by the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (BSA). All references below are BNSS-updated.

Case Type	Action
Cognizable (robbery, theft)	Information to Police under Section 173 BNSS (was §154 CrPC); action controlled by Police.
Non-cognizable (forgery)	Departmental investigation begins at once; police aid via Magistrate under Section 174 BNSS (was §155 CrPC).

MEMORY AID

§154 CrPC → **§173 BNSS** (cognizable / FIR). §155 CrPC → **§174 BNSS** (non-cognizable).

Rule 175 — Monetary Limits for Investigation

Authority competent for loss / fraud cases by principal amount involved (Directorate order w.e.f. 23/24.09.2021):

Investigating Officer	Monetary Limit
Inspector / ASPOs	Up to ₹2 lakh
Divisional Head / Chief or Senior PM	Above ₹2–95 lakh
AD / APMG (Regional / Circle Office)	Above ₹5–₹10 lakh
Director Postal Services & above	Above ₹10 lakh

NOTE

Limit is on the principal amount (incl. temporary misappropriation); interest is excluded. Cases above ₹10 lakh are reported by the Circle to the Directorate (raised from ₹5 lakh). Under Rule 34 of GFR, 2017, all losses above ₹50,000 from suspected fire/theft/fraud must be reported to the Police.

OMITTED — AND WHY

The detailed investigation procedure (Rules 176–225) — step-by-step enquiry conduct, recording of statements, departmental-vs-police coordination, FIR mechanics — is not reproduced. Reason: it is procedural and overlaps heavily with conduct/CCA and vigilance material covered elsewhere; objective papers from this volume target the headline rules (172-A, 175) and the monetary limits above.



Chapter 4 — Transmission under the Weighment System

How closed bags carried by rail are weighed for charging. The two “21st” dates and the M-105 procedure are the tested points.

Rule 226 — Weighment System

A system on Indian Railways where closed bags are conveyed in luggage vans **without a weight limit**. Mails are charged by weight; payment is half-yearly for a regular daily service and quarterly for occasional dispatches.

Rule 234 — Half-Yearly Weighment of Bags

- **Dates:** **21st January** and **21st July** each year.

Procedure — a statement in **Form M-105** in quadruplicate:

- Original & Duplicate → Stationmaster.
- Triplicate → Superintendent, RMS.
- Quadruplicate → office copy with work papers.

MEMORY AID — Two “21st” Dates

Weighment of bags = 21 Jan & 21 Jul. Don’t confuse with enumeration returns (Rule 155) = 8–21 Feb & 8–21 Aug.

OMITTED — AND WHY

Remaining weighment-charging clauses, and the Manual’s Appendices (I – treatment of Naval mails; II – issue of due-mail / sorting lists & conventions) and Annexure-A (period of preservation of records) are not detailed here. Reason: Naval-mail handling is a niche arrangement, and the record-preservation schedule is a reference list rather than examinable matter; the high-yield weighment facts are captured above.

Quick Revision — High-Yield Facts

Cover the right column and test yourself. These are the most-asked facts from the in-force rules.

Key Numbers

Point	Value
Station bundle	15+ articles
Territorial bundle	25+ articles
Registered bundle	More than 2 (min 3)
Insured bundle	More than 1 (min 2)
Separate insured bag if	Insured items usually exceed 10
Air-mail bag / TB weight	30 kg
Air cover instead of bag	Fewer than 50 articles
Regd. articles in air bag if	More than 25 (or bulky / with insured)
Bulk mailer	5,000 unregd. / 250 regd. at a time
Letter Mail Runner	14 kg
Parcel Bag (Trolley)	37 kg
Postman / Village Postman	10 kg
Special Parcel Runner	14 kg/parcel; 28 kg/man
Recall / alteration fee	₹6 (domestic) / ₹30 (intl.)
Foreign deficiency	“T” stamp; twice deficiency
Inland air-mail bill copies	6
Weighment of bags	21 Jan & 21 Jul
Enumeration returns	8–21 Feb & 8–21 Aug
Interception (statutory)	30 days; up to 90 days
Loss/fraud to Directorate	Above ₹10 lakh

Point	Value
Police reporting (GFR 2017)	Above ₹50,000
MO ceiling (Regs. 2024)	₹10,000

Designations & In-Charge

Office	In-Charge
Head Office / Sub-Office / Branch Office	Head PM / Sub-PM / Branch PM
Head Record Office (HRO)	Head Record Officer (HSG-I)
Sub-Record Office (SRO)	Sub Record Officer (LSG)
Record Office (RO)	Record Officer (SA)
Transit Mail Office (TMO)	Mail Agent / Mail Guard
Sorting / Mail Office	Head Sorting Assistant
RMS Division	Superintendent of RMS (SRM)

Framework & Network (Currency)

Item	Current Position
Parent Act	Post Office Act, 2023 (18.06.2024)
Rules / Regulations	Post Office Rules & Regulations, 2024 (16.12.2024)
Criminal law	BNSS / BNS / BSA, 2023 (01.07.2024)
Late fee	Abolished — G.S.R. 912(E), 29.12.2022
RLO	4 Zonal RLOs — Kolkata, Mumbai, Lucknow, Chennai
Speed Post hubs	NSH (~93) & ICH (~148) under MNOP
Registered hubs	L1 (~91) & L2 (~225); merged with SP hubs from 07.12.2024
MNOP / PNOP	Launched 2010 / 2018; KPIs incl. D+X

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